The Growth Story of Tamil Nadu



Tamil Nadu is one of the states having achieved rapid progress with a relatively short period, despite it started from appalling levels of poverty, deprivation and inequality.

During the short period, Tamil Nadu much to the consternation of many economists, initiated bold social programmes such as universal midday meals in primary schools and started putting in place an extensive social infrastructure – schools, health centres, roads, public transport, water supply, electricity connections, and much more. Today, Tamil Nadu has some of the best public services among all Indian states, and many of them are accessible to all on a non-discriminatory basis.

Last but not least, there is no evidence that the cultivation of human capability has been at the cost of conventional economic success, such as fast economic growth. Tamil Nadu have some of the highest per capita incomes and lowest poverty rates among all Indian states. Economic growth, in turn, has enabled these states to sustain and consolidate active social policies. This is an important example of the complementarity between economic growth and public support.

Source: *An Uncertain Glory* by Nobel laureate **Prof. Amartya Sen**.

Recap

- Development refers to the progress of a particular field or a particular person.
- Economic development means overall growth of all sectors of the economy.
- The major indicators of economic development are Per Capita Income, Net National Product, Purchasing Power Parity and Human Development Index.
- Human resource is necessary for the progress of any country.
- Sustainable development means development should take place without damaging the environment and preserve it for the future.
- The Wildlife Protection Act 1972 is aimed at protection to wild animals and birds.
- Thermal power plants emit large quantity of carbon dioxide, which is harmful to the environment

EXERCISE

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I. Choose the correct answer

1. **Assertion(A):**
Development increases the quality of life.

Reason(R): People will have higher incomes, better education, better health and nutrition, less poverty.

a. Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) explains (A)

b. Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) does not explain (A)

c. (A) is correct and (R) is false

d. (A) is false and (R) is true

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